KITS ADVISORY GROUP

STRIKE BITES — MANDATE MEETING PREPARATION BRIEFING

Physical Presence Protocol · Distribution Choreography · Discovery Question Bank

Document Class: Internal Advisory Preparation — Confidential
Reference: KAG-JRK-PREP-001
Applies To: Lead Advisor — Pre-Mandate Meeting with STRIKE BITES Owners & Investors
Standard: Investment Banking / MBB Advisory Level

PART ONE — PHYSICAL ARSENAL: WHAT TO CARRY INTO THE ROOM

The physical materials you bring to this meeting are not accessories. They are a **deliberate signal system** — each item communicates something about KITS's professionalism, preparation depth, and the seriousness of the engagement before a single word is spoken. In a Lebanese relationship-first business culture, the weight of what you carry in is felt before it is read.

ITEM 1 — THE BOUND PITCH DECK (Printed, Professional Grade)

Quantity: One copy per confirmed attendee + two extra (for absent principals, secretary, or the owner who wants to take one home)
Format: A4, full-color, professionally printed, double-sided, wire-bound or perfect-bound with a soft-touch laminate cover
Cover: STRIKE BITES brand identity — obsidian black background, STRIKE logotype in performance gold, KITS Advisory Group credit line at the bottom
Inside: Speaker notes pages omitted — the printed copy is the client's copy, not yours. It should look like a publication, not a handout.

Why it matters:
Printed decks physically remain in the room when laptops close. They occupy the table during deliberation and travel home after the meeting. In partner-level meetings at advisory firms and VC houses, the deck that stays on the conference table during private discussion is worth more than any digital file. A soft-touch laminated bound document signals: *this is not a draft. This is a delivery.*

When to distribute: Do NOT place on the table before the presentation begins. Keep the copies face-down or in the folders at your seat. Distribute only when reaching the financial section or at the natural "I want you to follow along here" moment — or hold entirely until the close and present as part of the leave-behind package. (See Part Three for full distribution choreography.)

ITEM 2 — THE KITS BRANDED PRESENTATION FOLDER

Quantity: One per attendee
Format: A4 hard-cover portfolio folder, obsidian black, debossed or foil-stamped with KITS Advisory Group or STRIKE BITES branding
Contents inside the folder (pre-loaded):

- The bound pitch deck (or) the executive summary one-pager
- The mandate document (1 copy, unsigned, for reference)
- A KITS business card tucked into the inside left pocket

Why it matters:
The folder is the *first physical contact* the client has with KITS. It sets the aesthetic register before the screen turns on. Lebanese business culture places high value on visible effort and tangible quality — a premium physical package is not excessive; it is expected at this level. In MENA advisory contexts, the quality of the physical material directly influences the perceived quality of the advisory work.

ITEM 3 — THE EXECUTIVE SUMMARY ONE-PAGER

Quantity: One per attendee + 3 extras
Format: A4 or A3 folded, premium paper, single page (front and back acceptable)
Contents:

- KITS / STRIKE BITES header
- Problem: The empty Lebanese premium snacking category
- Solution: STRIKE BITES — Lebanese premium beef jerky, performance-positioned
- Market size (key headline figure from the feasibility study)
- KITS's scope: 11 pre-mandate deliverables already completed
- Three advisory tiers: Lean ($18,500) / Standard ($42,000) / Full Market Entry ($82,000)
- The ask in writing: "Which tier do we begin with?"
- KITS contact and reference number

Why it matters:
The one-pager serves three functions: (1) a 90-second read for any investor in the room who has not been fully briefed beforehand, (2) a reference card the client keeps separate from the full deck, and (3) the document that gets forwarded to absent principals who were not at the meeting. It must work as a standalone document and as a supplement. The extra copies are critical in Lebanese business culture — family members, business partners, and attorneys who were not in the room routinely receive materials afterwards.

ITEM 4 — THE MANAGEMENT MANDATE DOCUMENT (Pre-Signed by KITS)

Quantity: Two printed copies (one for client signature, one for KITS records)
Format: A4, clean legal-style layout, printed on slightly heavier paper than regular office stock, placed inside a separate envelope or folder
Status: KITS principal's signature already applied. Only the client's signature is missing.
What it communicates: KITS has already committed. The only remaining action is the client's decision.

When to bring it out: Only at the close — not before. This is not a document you wave around. When the time comes, you slide it across the table with two words: *"It's ready."*

Why it matters:
A pre-signed mandate document is a powerful closing instrument. It reduces the number of actions the client must take to one: sign. It also demonstrates KITS's conviction — you signed before they did. In psychological terms, this is a reciprocity trigger combined with commitment reduction. The easier you make it to say yes, the more likely a yes becomes.

ITEM 5 — THE PRODUCT SAMPLE (If Physically Available)

Quantity: Enough product for every person in the room to taste
Format: Placed in small branded cups or premium food-service packaging — not ripped open from a bag
Timing: Introduce at the product section of the deck — or as an opening engagement device once rapport has been established
Framing: *"Before we go further — this is what we are building the business around. Please."*

Why it matters:
A physical product sample is the single most powerful proof-of-concept device available in a food brand pitch. No financial model, no market research, and no brand study creates the same

conviction as the client tasting the product and finding it genuinely good. It engages a sense (taste) that no screen can replicate. It also instantly personalizes the conversation — "I like it. My kids would eat this." — and anchors the meeting in the concrete reality of what is being built.

If product is not yet available: Replace with high-quality photographic prints of the product mockup (from the brand enhancement study / product visualization). Frame one and place it on the table. Even a printed visual of the product keeps the meeting grounded in the physical reality of the brand.

ITEM 6 — KITS BUSINESS CARDS

Quantity: Minimum 10
Format: Premium card stock, matte or soft-touch finish, KITS brand design
When to distribute: On arrival, during introductions — before sitting down
Lebanese cultural note: The exchange of business cards is a relationship moment, not a formality. Present yours with both hands or a slight incline. Accept theirs with attention — look at it, acknowledge it, place it respectfully on the table rather than pocketing it immediately.

ITEM 7 — YOUR DIGITAL PRESENTATION SETUP

What to bring:

- Your laptop, fully charged, presentation loaded and tested
- HDMI and USB-C adapters for every likely display connector (do not assume the meeting room has yours)
- A wireless presenter/clicker (a laser pointer on the clicker is appropriate in a boardroom)
- A personal hotspot (do not rely on venue WiFi for a presentation of this importance)
- A USB drive with the full presentation file as backup
- The deck downloaded and cached as PDF on both your laptop and phone

Why the redundancy: The one thing that cannot happen in this meeting is a technical failure that breaks your momentum. Technical difficulty in a high-stakes pitch produces a specific type of awkward silence that undermines authority and signals unprofessionalism. Prepare so that losing any one device or connection does not interrupt the flow.

ITEM 8 — YOUR NOTEPAD AND PEN (Premium Quality)

Format: A proper leather-bound notebook, not a spiral-pad. A quality pen.
Purpose: The discovery section of the meeting (Part Four of this document) requires active note-taking. When you write down what the client says, you signal that it matters. In a Lebanese/MENA business culture context, visible note-taking during a listening session is a mark of respect. It also produces the raw intelligence you need to adjust your financial section in real time.

ITEM 9 — THE DELIVERY BAG OR ATTACHÉ

Format: A structured leather briefcase or attaché — not a backpack, not a laptop sleeve
Why: What you carry communicates who you are before you speak. An attaché signals an advisor. A backpack signals a freelancer. At this level of engagement, every signal reinforces or undermines authority.

PART TWO — DISTRIBUTION CHOREOGRAPHY: WHEN EACH ITEM HITS THE TABLE

The sequence in which you introduce physical materials is as important as the materials themselves. Flooding the table at the start kills focus. Hoarding everything until the end wastes the sensory and psychological power of each item. The choreography below maps each item to a specific moment in the meeting flow.

PHASE 1 — ARRIVAL AND GREETING (Before sitting down)

Item	Action
Business cards	Exchange on arrival, during introductions
Attire	Formal business — suit, polished shoes, understated colour
Attaché / folder	Carried in closed, placed at your seat when sitting
Nothing on the table yet	The table should be clear — your presence is the first impression

The principle: Before a word of business is spoken, every physical signal should communicate: *this person is serious, prepared, and at ease.* Laying materials out before the meeting begins is the physical equivalent of over-explaining.

PHASE 2 — DISCOVERY SESSION (Opening Section — You Listen First)

Item	Action
Notepad and pen	Open and visible — you are here to listen
Nothing else distributed	The client is speaking. Nothing competes.
One-pager	Held back — do not introduce yet

The principle: This phase is about the client, not KITS. Your job is to collect intelligence and demonstrate that you listen before you present. A clean table signals that you are not in a rush to sell.

PHASE 3 — PRESENTATION (Main Pitch)

Item	Action
Laptop / screen on	From the beginning of the deck
Bound deck — distribute	When reaching Section 4 (Financial) or when a client reaches for paper — not before
Product sample	At the product section, or as an icebreaker opener if rapport is strong
Product mock-up visual	Placed on the table at the brand section
One-pager	Do not distribute yet — hold for close

Alternative approach (for a strong analytical audience): Distribute the bound deck face-down at the start with the instruction: *"I'd like to walk you through this together — please don't flip ahead, everything will make more sense in sequence."* This is the standard MBB approach when the audience is analytically sophisticated and will read ahead.

PHASE 4 — THE CLOSE

Item	Action
Mandate document	Slide across the table — "It's ready."
One-pager	Distribute now, as a memory device for the tier and the ask
Bound deck (if not yet given)	Distribute now as the leave-behind
Your pen	Placed on the table near the mandate, not handed to them

The principle: The physical act of sliding a pre-signed document across the table is the most powerful closing gesture available. It reduces the client's required action to one movement. Combined with the silence discipline (hold 30–40 seconds after asking the closing question), this is the close.

PHASE 5 — POST-MEETING DEPARTURE AND LEAVE-BEHINDS

Item	Action
Branded folder (one per person, fully loaded)	Left behind — each person takes theirs
Extra bound decks (2 copies)	Left for absent principals or family members who will be consulted
Extra one-pagers (3 copies)	Left on the table — they will circulate
USB drive (optional)	Only if specifically requested
Digital PDF	Sent within 2 hours of the meeting — email to every confirmed attendee

The "24-hour rule": Answer every question raised in the meeting that you could not answer on the spot within 24–48 hours by email. This is not optional — it is the professional standard that separates advisors from consultants. Failure to follow up on open questions within 48 hours signals that the thoroughness was performative.

PART THREE — THE DISCOVERY QUESTION BANK

Purpose and Framing

The opening section of the STRIKE BITES pitch is a listening session. You are not gathering information for its own sake — you are doing two things simultaneously:

1. Building rapport and demonstrating intelligence. The quality of your questions tells the client more about your sophistication than any slide you will show. A well-constructed question reveals that you have already done your homework and are asking because you want *their specific situation*, not generic background.

2. Identifying existing infrastructure that can be cross-deployed to STRIKE BITES, reducing the budget requirements and strengthening the financial case. If the client's other businesses already have a lawyer on retainer, a logistics fleet, an offshore account, an IT system, or a digital agency — KITS can cross-charge or cross-deploy those resources, dropping the STRIKE BITES launch cost materially. This makes the financial section *more compelling*, not more expensive.

HOW TO OPEN THE DISCOVERY SESSION

State your intent explicitly — it builds trust and signals a systems-level advisor mindset:

> *"Before I take you through what we've built, I want to spend 15–20 minutes understanding your existing operation. You have multiple businesses running. My job is to make sure we don't duplicate what already exists and that STRIKE BITES benefits from everything you've already built. So I have some questions — please be as open as you're comfortable being, because everything you tell me will make the financial picture better for you."*

DOMAIN 1 — CORPORATE STRUCTURE & LEGAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Objective: Understand existing legal entities, retained counsel, and registration infrastructure that STRIKE BITES might share or leverage.

1. How many legal entities do you currently operate — SALs, SALRs, individual trading names — and are any of them in the food or consumer goods space?
2. Do you have a lawyer or law firm on retainer currently? Is it a general retainer or transactional only?
3. Have you previously registered a trademark in Lebanon or the GCC? If so, through which attorney or IP firm?

4. Do any of your existing companies hold active MoPH or Ministère de la Santé approvals or product registrations?
5. Is there a notary or commercial registry contact you use regularly for filings?

How you use the answers: If a lawyer is already on retainer, STRIKE BITES may be able to conduct trademark filing and legal advisory as an add-on rather than a new engagement — directly reducing the legal & regulatory budget line by $1,000–$2,500.

DOMAIN 2 — BANKING & FINANCIAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Objective: Identify existing banking relationships — especially offshore and USD accounts — that are critical for STRIKE BITES's international supplier payments.

1. Do any of your businesses currently hold an offshore USD account — Cyprus, UAE, Malta, or similar?
2. Do you have an established relationship with a Lebanese bank that handles commercial USD transfers? Which bank?
3. Have you previously sent international SWIFT transfers to suppliers or partners — Turkey, Europe, GCC?
4. Do any of your businesses use a payment processor for credit card or online transactions?
5. Have you worked with a currency broker or FX service for importing goods into Lebanon?

How you use the answers: If an offshore USD account already exists, the $1,500–$2,000 banking setup line in the Standard tier disappears entirely. If established SWIFT relationships exist, transfer costs are already absorbed. In the financial section, you can flag this directly: *"If we can use your existing Cyprus account, we remove this line from the budget — that's $2,000 directly to your bottom line."*

DOMAIN 3 — ACCOUNTING & FINANCIAL REPORTING

Objective: Understand the existing financial management infrastructure to avoid duplicating bookkeeping, audit, or CFO-level functions.

1. Do you have a CFO, finance director, or controller who manages group-level financials?
2. Which accounting or audit firm handles your filings currently?
3. Are your businesses currently filing with NSSF and the Lebanese Tax Authority regularly?
4. Do you have an accounting software system in use — QuickBooks, Zoho Books, SAP, or similar?

5. Is there a management accountant or bookkeeper who handles monthly P&L across your businesses?

How you use the answers: If a group accountant is already paid $500–$800/month for other businesses, STRIKE BITES bookkeeping can be allocated as a fractional extension of that cost — potentially eliminating the standalone bookkeeper line in the budget.

DOMAIN 4 — TECHNOLOGY & IT SYSTEMS

Objective: Identify existing IT infrastructure — ERP, POS, CRM, server environments — that could support STRIKE BITES operations without new investment.

1. Do any of your businesses use a CRM system — Salesforce, HubSpot, Zoho, or a custom solution?
2. Do you have an ERP or inventory management system running for any of your businesses?
3. Is there an internal IT team, an IT manager on staff, or an IT company on retainer?
4. Do any of your businesses run POS systems — either retail or distributor-facing?
5. Do you have a domain hosting provider or cloud infrastructure (AWS, Google Cloud, Azure) already in use?

How you use the answers: A CRM system already licensed for another business can be extended to STRIKE BITES for zero additional software cost. This removes the CRM setup line from the technology budget. An existing IT retainer can handle STRIKE BITES email, cloud storage, and basic tech support.

DOMAIN 5 — WEB, APP & DIGITAL DEVELOPMENT

Objective: Determine whether existing digital development resources can be applied to STRIKE BITES's website and e-commerce infrastructure.

1. Do any of your businesses currently have a website you're satisfied with? Who built it?
2. Do you have a web developer or digital agency you work with regularly?
3. Have any of your businesses operated an e-commerce platform — Shopify, WooCommerce, Magento, or custom?
4. Do you have a social media manager or digital content producer on staff or contracted?
5. Do any of your businesses already have Instagram, Facebook, or TikTok accounts with meaningful audiences that could cross-promote a new brand?

How you use the answers: If a web developer is already under contract, the STRIKE BITES website build can be scoped into their existing agreement rather than commissioning a new agency. This can save $1,500–$3,000 of digital build costs. An existing social audience is a distribution asset that has a direct bearing on the marketing budget tier recommendation.

DOMAIN 6 — LOGISTICS, DISTRIBUTION & WAREHOUSING

Objective: This is the highest-value infrastructure domain for STRIKE BITES. Existing logistics infrastructure can dramatically reduce the operational cost of first-placement delivery, restock, and route-to-market.

1. Do any of your businesses own or operate a vehicle fleet — vans, trucks, light delivery vehicles?
2. Do you have a warehouse, storage facility, or commercial space with temperature-controlled or standard dry storage?
3. Do you have an existing relationship with a freight forwarder or customs broker in Lebanon?
4. Do any of your businesses distribute or deliver goods to retail outlets, gyms, pharmacies, or food service channels currently?
5. Do you work with a 3PL (third-party logistics) company for any of your businesses?
6. Do you have route-to-market experience — drivers with existing trade relationships in specific geographies of Beirut or the North?

How you use the answers: This is your biggest cost compression lever. A delivery van already operated by another business can handle STRIKE BITES first placements as a shared route — eliminating the logistics vehicle cost and dramatically reducing field execution costs. Existing warehouse space removes cold-storage and renting fees. Existing customs broker relationships reduce import processing time and fees. Frame this directly in the financial section: *"If your fleet can handle the first 60 placements, we restructure the logistics line and your net launch cost drops by approximately $X."*

DOMAIN 7 — HUMAN RESOURCES & STAFFING

Objective: Identify existing staff who could be cross-deployed or partially allocated to STRIKE BITES, reducing headcount costs.

1. Do you have an HR department or HR manager handling employment contracts, NSSF, and staff administration?

2. Do any of your businesses employ sales representatives, account managers, or field staff?
3. Do you have administrative staff — an executive assistant, operations coordinator, or office manager — who handles cross-business tasks?
4. Is there a purchasing or procurement officer who handles supplier negotiations and purchase orders for any of your businesses?
5. Do any of your existing staff have food industry, FMCG, retail, or distribution experience?

How you use the answers: A shared sales representative or field executive who is already paid can take on STRIKE BITES account visits as part of an expanded scope, at a fraction of the cost of hiring dedicated headcount. Administrative staff can handle reorder coordination without a separate hire. Frame this as cross-investment: *"We can structure their STRIKE BITES allocation as a supplemental scope within their current contract — costing you 20% of a new hire."*

DOMAIN 8 — MARKETING, CREATIVE & MEDIA

Objective: Understand existing creative and marketing assets, agency relationships, and media contacts that can be mobilized for STRIKE BITES.

1. Do any of your businesses work with a creative or branding agency currently?
2. Do you have a graphic designer — in-house or freelance — you use for marketing materials?
3. Do any of your businesses work with a photographer or videographer for commercial content?
4. Have any of your businesses run paid media campaigns — Google, Meta, or outdoor in Lebanon?
5. Do you have a PR contact or media relationships in Lebanon that have been used for any of your businesses?
6. Are there any existing sponsorship relationships — events, gyms, sports clubs — that could cross over to STRIKE BITES?

How you use the answers: An existing creative agency relationship can be extended to cover STRIKE BITES packaging finalisation, launch collateral, and social content — at a negotiated add-on rate rather than a new client rate. Existing media relationships create immediate earned media value that is not in the base marketing budget.

DOMAIN 9 — REGULATORY, GOVERNMENT & INSTITUTIONAL RELATIONS

Objective: Determine whether existing government or institutional relationships can accelerate STRIKE BITES's regulatory filings and approvals.

1. Have any of your businesses previously registered a food or consumer goods product with the Lebanese Ministry of Public Health (MoPH)?
2. Do you have existing relationships with anyone at Dar Al-Fatwa or any Halal certification body?
3. Have you worked with LIBNOR for lab testing or quality certification before?
4. Do you have any government relations, wasta, or institutional contacts that could be relevant to food product registration or trade facilitation?
5. Have any of your businesses exported goods — and if so, do you have an established customs and export documentation process?

How you use the answers: An existing MoPH relationship or a prior successful registration dramatically reduces the risk and timeline associated with Blocker 1 (MoPH registration). A Dar Al-Fatwa contact accelerates Halal certification. If any of these relationships exist, the regulatory risk section of the financial model shifts from "uncertain" to "managed" — which directly improves the confidence interval on the launch timeline and justifies a tighter financial projection.

DOMAIN 10 — EXISTING BUSINESS PORTFOLIO & COMMERCIAL CONTEXT

Objective: Build a complete picture of the client's business ecosystem to understand their appetite, capacity, and decision-making style.

1. Can you walk me through your current businesses — what sectors, what stage, what scale?
2. Which of your businesses is currently your most operationally demanding? And which is the most profitable?
3. Have you launched a brand or product from scratch before — or have most businesses been acquisitions or established operations?
4. How do you typically make investment decisions — do you centralise budget approval, or do each of your businesses operate with independent P&Ls?
5. Who are the key people in your operation beyond those in this room — do you have a managing director, operations head, or board member who would need to sign off on this engagement?
6. What is your personal connection to STRIKE BITES — is this a passion project, a pure investment, or part of a broader portfolio strategy?
7. What does success look like to you at 12 months? And at 3 years?

How you use the answers: Question 4 tells you where budget authority sits — critical for knowing whether the decision can be made in this room. Question 5 tells you whether there is an absent decision-maker who must be won over (meaning your leave-behind strategy becomes more important than your in-room close). Questions 6 and 7 are the most important of all — they tell you what emotionally motivates this investment, allowing you to calibrate your entire narrative to what they actually care about.

PART FOUR — APPLYING DISCOVERY INTELLIGENCE IN REAL TIME

The Cross-Investment Savings Framework

During the financial section of the pitch, you have the opportunity to do something no generic advisory pitch can do: you can reduce the quoted budget in real time based on what you just learned. This is the most powerful financial move available to you.

Structure it as a live table:

> *"Based on what you've shared with me, here is what changes in the budget."*

Infrastructure Already in Place	**Budget Line Removed or Reduced**	**Estimated Saving**
Existing offshore USD account	Banking setup removed	$1,500–$2,000
Existing legal retainer	Legal advisory scope reduced	$800–$1,500
Existing vehicle fleet	First-placement logistics reduced	$1,200–$2,000
Existing group accountant	Bookkeeper line reduced	$1,800–$3,600 (annual)
Existing web developer	Website build reduced	$1,500–$2,500
Existing CRM system	Technology setup removed	$600–$1,200
Existing creative agency	Design & content reduced	$800–$1,500
Existing warehouse space	Storage costs removed	$1,200–$2,400 (annual)
Potential total saving	**Depending on scope**	**$4,000–$12,000+**

The effect of this table is significant: the Standard tier quoted at $42,000 may effectively become a $30,000–$38,000 net cost once cross-investment savings are applied. This makes the mandate materially easier to approve — and it demonstrates that KITS is not selling a fixed product but engineering a custom solution.

> *"The number on the slide is the base case. Your actual net cost, given what you already have in place, is lower. Let's build the real number together."*

This is the line that closes rooms.

The Decision-Trigger Question

After the discovery session, at the end of the financial presentation, synthesize what you have learned into a single personalized statement before the formal close:

> *"Everything you've told me confirms that this is the right moment — and that you are already better positioned than most clients who start this conversation. You have [X, Y, Z already in place]. That reduces your true cost, compresses your risk, and means we can move faster than the base-case timeline. The category is empty today. The question is simply: which tier do we activate, and do we start the clock today?"*

Then stop talking.

PART FIVE — PRE-MEETING CHECKLIST

48 Hours Before

- [ ] Confirm attendee list — names, titles, roles, relationship to each other
- [ ] Print bound decks (one per confirmed attendee + 2 extra)
- [ ] Print one-pagers (one per attendee + 3 extra)
- [ ] Print mandate documents (2 copies)
- [ ] Prepare and organise branded folders (pre-loaded)
- [ ] Charge laptop, clicker, hotspot
- [ ] Load deck on laptop, tablet, USB drive, and cache as PDF
- [ ] Test HDMI and USB-C adapters
- [ ] Prepare product sample presentation (if product available)
- [ ] Review all financial figures — only the v2.0 corrected figures are spoken aloud
- [ ] Review the discovery question bank — memorise the 10 domains, not the individual questions
- [ ] Prepare the cross-investment savings table as a working document (not printed — built live)

Day of Meeting

- [ ] Arrive 15 minutes early — assess the room, connect the display, confirm the setup
- [ ] Arrange materials at your seat (not yet on the table)

- [ ] Place one branded folder at each seat — this is acceptable before people arrive
- [ ] Test the clicker and verify the first slide is displayed correctly
- [ ] Check that the product sample is at the correct temperature and presentation standard
- [ ] Have your notepad open and pen accessible before the client enters

Post-Meeting (Within 2 Hours)

- [ ] Send PDF of the pitch deck and one-pager to all confirmed attendees by email
- [ ] Send a brief, warm summary note — one paragraph — referencing the specific things they said that resonated most
- [ ] Log every open question raised in the meeting that was not answered
- [ ] Respond to every open question within 24–48 hours
- [ ] If the mandate was not signed in the room, attach the mandate document to the follow-up email with a gentle, non-pressured note: *"The document is attached — review at your convenience. I'm available to answer anything before you decide."*

PART SIX — CULTURAL PROTOCOL NOTES (LEBANESE CONTEXT)

1. **The meeting will likely start late.** Build this into your energy. Do not show impatience; use the time to deepen rapport and personal conversation. The meeting's real business often starts 10–15 minutes after the nominal start time.
2. **Hierarchy is visible.** Address the most senior person in the room most directly. Eye contact and direct address to the principal signals respect. Avoid inadvertently pitching to the junior staff while the principal waits.
3. **Family and personal conversation is business.** Accept and reciprocate questions about family, home, background. This is not small talk — it is the relationship audit that determines trust.
4. **Never contradict or embarrass publicly.** If a financial claim or a business assumption from the client's side needs correcting, do it privately, gently, and later — or frame it as new information: *"The research actually revealed something interesting here..."*
5. **Hospitality is mandatory.** Accept coffee, tea, or water. Refusing is a mild social offence. If you are the host, ensure refreshments are arranged.
6. **"Inshallah" is not a no.** In a Lebanese negotiation, "inshallah" can mean genuine deference to fate, a polite deferral, or quiet agreement. Read the surrounding context. Do not push for explicit confirmation when "inshallah" has been offered warmly.
7. **Multiple copies of everything.** Decision-making in Lebanese family-owned businesses frequently involves consultation with individuals who were not in the room — a spouse, a brother, a silent partner, a trusted advisor. Extra printed materials are not wasteful; they are the pathway to a decision.

8. **The bargaining expectation.** Be prepared for a counter on the tier price. If the client pushes back, the response is not to discount the tier — it is to offer a scope reduction that brings them to a lower tier while preserving the per-unit price integrity. The three-tier structure was designed for exactly this negotiation.

Document prepared by KITS Advisory Group for internal use only.

Reference: KAG-JRK-PREP-001

All figures and projections reference the corrected v2.0 financial model only.